

STREAMLINING D.C. BENEFITS ACCESS THROUGH RPA

Government of D.C. DHS | Office of Information Systems (OIS)

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Keywords:

Workflow integrations, process automation, robotic process automation (RPA), data extraction, software robots

Summary:

To streamline manual processes managing benefits and benefit access, Janet worked with the DHS Office of Information Systems to design and build 2 automated processes from scratch that simplified data extraction and benefit recertifications. Using **Power Automate Desktop**, **OCR**, and **PowerShell scripts**, Janet created an automation that would reliably extract relevant data from a task management application before securely transporting it, enabling an ongoing **2+ year initiative** dedicated towards searching for duplicate people in benefits to move forward. She also created an automation that truncated a **35+ step process** to send interview notices to eligible SNAP recipients. Kickstarting the recertification process, this project would help increase the timeliness rates for staff and help nearly **70,000+ SNAP cases**., impacting **~ 10% of D.C. current population**, get their SNAP benefits faster.

Streamlining D.C. Benefits Access Through Robotic Process Automation

Department of Human Services (DHS)

Washington D.C.

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coding it forward >



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OVER 10 WEEKS...

- **Working within the Office of Information Systems (OIS)**
 - Managing, overseeing, and supporting all activities of the agency and that it aligns with the mission of DHS
 - OIS executing DHS mission through information technology
- **Opportunity to build 2 automation projects**
 1. Gathering data to help prevent and flag potential duplicate people
 2. Sending interview notices regarding SNAP benefit recertification to a group of individuals

DEFINING AUTOMATION

Robotic Process Automation (RPA)

Robot that mimics human actions—a **digital assistant**!

- Not AI!
- Process > Data
- For repetitive, rule based, manual tasks
- Predefined set of rules or steps

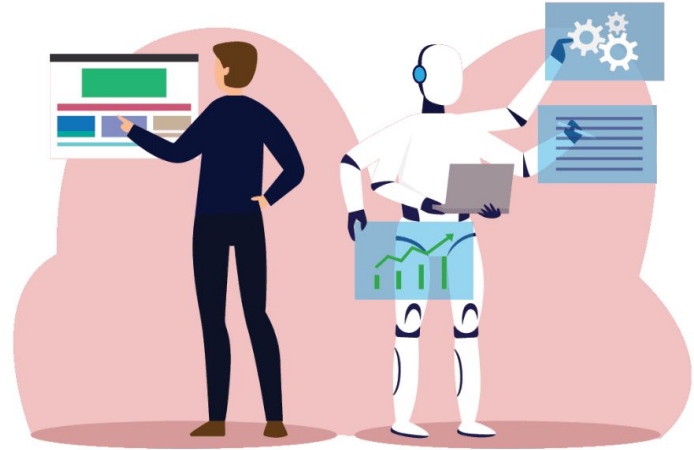


Image from <https://digital.gov/guides/rpa/rpa-playbook>

TASK DETAIL REPORTS (TDR)

The Need

- Ongoing project needs relevant, daily data to check for duplicates
- No automatic, systematic way of grabbing relevant submitted benefit cases = No kickoff for next step

Why it matters

- Streamlines case processing
- Smoothens experience for developers
- Creates a reliable method of data extraction
- Enables project continuation

NOTICE OF INTERVIEW PROCESS (NoIP)

The Need

- Repetitive 35+ step process to send interview notices to X number of SNAP recipients
- No automatic, systematic way of grabbing relevant cases daily

Why it matters

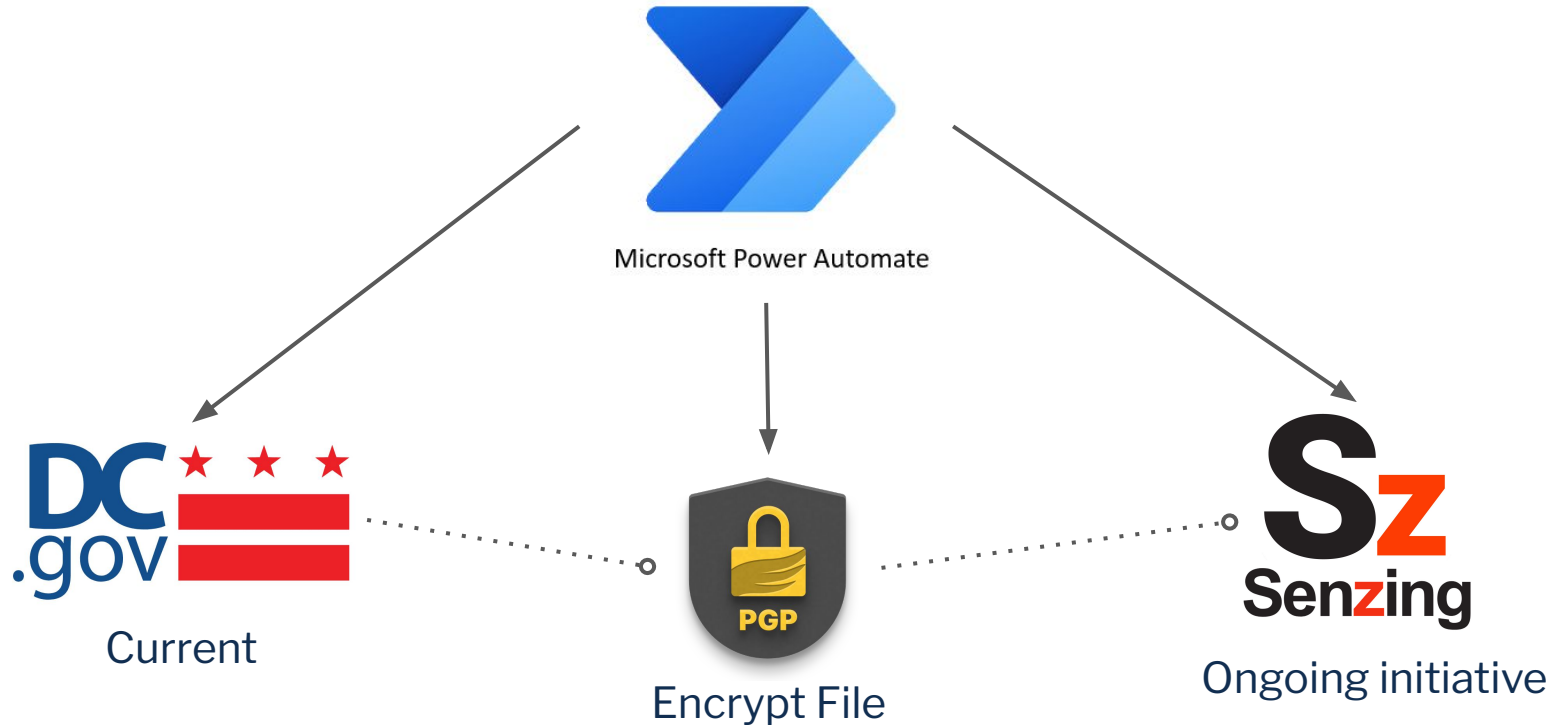
- Less time processing/waiting in the queue
- ~10% of D.C. residents are SNAP recipients
- Case workers can focus on reviewing requests and/or more complex cases

PROCESS & OUTCOMES

And everything in between

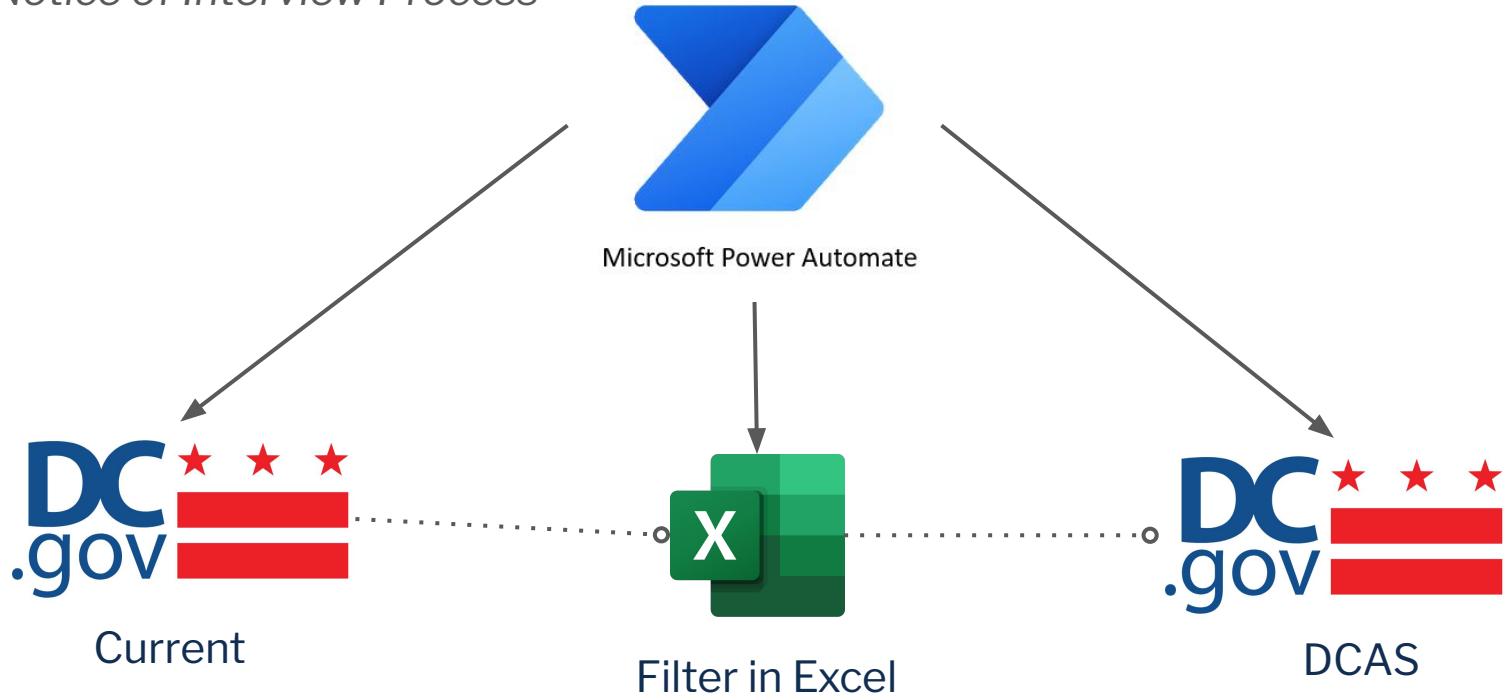
TDR AUTOMATION PIPELINE

TDR: Task Detail Reports



NoIP AUTOMATION PIPELINE

NoIP: Notice of Interview Process



OUTCOMES

For Staff

- Increases efficiency
 - Saves time–5 minutes per case
 - Minimizes repetitive tasks
- Shift focus to more complex, technical problems/needs
- Improve timeliness
- Enables larger initiative to move forward
- One platform maintenance

For Benefit Recipients

- Receive quicker recertification notices
- Convene quicker with case workers
- Prevent confusion and minimize benefit distribution errors

REFLECTIONS

- Asking questions and thinking outside the box
- Importance of testing and security
- Emphasis on interdisciplinary teams
- Impact of technology on our communities

THANK YOU!

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